

09-10 Performance Review

Manager Review

Jonathan Daniel Micklos

Performance Review: 04/01/2009 - 03/31/2010

Reviewer: Devraj Varadhan

Role: Manager

Status: Completed

Manager: Devraj Varadhan

Overall Performance Summary

Employee Summary:

In this past year, our team has gone through many changes and greatly developed (as a team), all the while accomplishing quite a lot. As part of the team, I was a direct part of that.

In the goals below, I talk about my work with Twister Category Expansion; the implementation of the Detail Page Framework, the Twister AppConfig, Single Code Path and the Shadow Children Fix; Twister for Books backend and frontend; keeping TCO low through service and hardware management; configuring tools such as WATER to keep down operations overhead; and my work with the Ubiquity project and starting the Ubiquity at Amazon community.

Two projects worth mentioning that are not otherwise mentioned in this review are the VariationsMetadataCache Deprecation project and my work to bring CARS back to life back in early 2009.

Until recently, the VMDC has been responsible for storing variation dimension title value such as "Size", "Color", "Shape" and "Flavor". This system provides these words (and many others) in the languages in the 4 locales it resides. This system has been replaced with calls to the Amazon string translator. I have been responsible for the implementation of the replacement code for the legacy VMDC calls, verifying the usage of the VMDC and driving said usage down. The only tasks remaining with the VMDC deprecation are to get the RPA to stop calling it, remove the Apollo environments it uses and to repurpose the hosts. I am responsible for those tasks.

In early 2009, CARS was brought down by a series of upgrades and other events. I spent the better part of a month getting the CARS TPEDs, AMP Queues, CARSMessagesProcessors and CARSRankedDataReaderServices back up and running. In order to do this, I had to work with the teams responsible for maintaining the TPED and AMP Queue code. I also worked with the Item Master team.

Apart from these accomplishments, this year was a major year for my development as a Software Development Engineer. During this year, I have seen 3 manager switches made. This has made performance tracking difficult. As a result, I have been working hard to get consistent feedback from my peers and manager(s), make changes as needed and confirm those changes with my peers and manager(s).

I have sought out feedback from my peers in regards to my performance. With reflection, and execution of a plan, I have been able to improve the quality of my work in both the code that I submit and the code that I review. I have also improved on my ability to prioritize work. In our sphere of the

company, work can be easily made hectic with randomization from various sources. It is absolutely crucial that I have the ability to prioritize the tasks born from this randomization and forward them on when need be. Getting proper feedback and acting upon the feedback given has given me a path to truly grow this past year.

Additionally, I have sought out education in order to grow as a developer. In this past year I have taken the Santana and Operations classes at Amazon. I have looked into internal Amazon tools for solving some of our teams problems. A good example of this would be the WATER Trouble Ticket Auto Responder. Combined with a Wiki I started, I was able to bring down operations by automatically directing Trouble Ticket submitters to self help tools.

In regards to external technologies, I have spent the time needed to familiarize myself with those which we use such as jQuery. I also spent time on technologies which were not currently being used at Amazon, but which I thought could be useful for us. One such example would be my work with the Ubiquity project and bringing it to Amazon. I believe that my work with both Ubiquity and Operations show not only my interest in continuing education, but my propensity to exhibit the "just do it" attitude.

This has been a year of development for myself and our team. We are not only seeing return on investment for the various projects we have worked on in this past year, but will continue to see return on the development we have made as a team and I have made as a developer in this coming year.

Manager Summary:

Overall it was a year of mixed results for you and your own summary highlights some of the challenges and achievements. In the first ½ year, your performance fell below expectations – Specifically in delivering quality work, comprehensiveness and sticking to schedule commitments. You rightly recognized this, worked actively with your team (last 6 months) to understand the impact and the results that you have shown is very encouraging – your recent work in launching twister books in CA, twister books phase 2.5 are proofs to that. On the leadership aspect, you consistently demonstrated amazon.com's core values. You are known for your ownership & commitment, and hard work among you peers. Keep it up.

Your performance is in the right trajectory, shown clear improvements and it is important for you to continue to sustain these improvements as you take on new goals / challenges this year. Wish you the very best, here's to a productive 2010.

Performance Goals

Expand Twister Solution in 18 Categories

Category expansion - Launch existing twister variation solution to the following categories:

Electronics – DE,US,FR,UK

PC - US, DE

Off. Products – US

VG – DE,UK,JP,FR

HPC – UK, FR

Toys-US

Support Category Expansion Team in the launch of Twister for new stores:

Baby – FR

Beauty – FR

Shoes – FR

Employee Summary:

Between the work of the Twister Team and the Category Expansion Team, we were able to launch twister in the those afore mentioned categories. Specifically, I configured Twister and/or Twister with DPF/SCP in:

- DE
- Photo
- CE
- Apparel
- Baby
- Beauty
- HPC
- Shoes
- Sports
- Videogames
- JP
- CE
- apparel
- baby
- grocery
- HPC
- UK
- apparel
- beauty
- shoes
- sports

and re-enabled Twister in US CE. I also gave support to the Category Expansion Team by helping them Twisterize categories in FR.

The work that I have done to Twisterize these categories has included configuring the App Config, the Twister Config, the front and back end Image and EMWA configs, and modifying various features so that they are ready to work with Twister. Features that I have worked on over the last year to work with Twister include (but aren't limited to):

- MAP
- Buyxgety
- HQP
- Product-Title
- QPE

Manager Summary:

Thank you for your continued efforts on the category expansions. This is an important milestone for the company and the twister program. Though, twister-on-demand is scheduled to be done from from India, I encourage you to provide inputs during the scope definition as well as during the technical design stage.

Deliver DPF, Twister Appconfig and SCP WW

Deliver newly designed Detail page framework, Appconfig & Single Code Path WW in a timely and quality manner. This is an important milestone for expanding Twister WW and equally important step for you / and the team as SCP / DPF allows twister team to focus and innovate on the core twister features (by decoupling the tight coupling from rest of DP features with twister)

Employee Summary:

The Detail Page Framework and Single Code Path projects have been launched in all 5 of the

locales that the Twister Matrix currently resides. For that effort, not only did I help in the development of the Detail Page Framework, but I also helped in the conversion of many categories from non-DPF/non-SCP enabled to DPF and SCP enabled.

For the development of the Detail Page Framework, the major components I worked on were the inheritance model implementation of the Detail Page Framework config and the string handler built into the Detail Page Framework. I have worked on other additions to the Detail Page Framework as well.

Once the Detail Page Framework was completed in its initial form, I gave a brownbag over it. The brownbag covered the high level functionality of the Detail Page Framework and how feature owners could leverage it to control cross feature communication through events, AJAX requests to the website and the handling of events on the Detail Page.

The new Detail Page Framework and Single Code Path code changes have enabled category expansion teams and feature owners to more easily integrate Twister into their work. It has been a major win for our team and RCX in general!

Manager Summary:

SCP & DPF is a significant and challenging milestone for you and the team. We had several setbacks in our testing & execution (internal not in prod) but successfully launched in production. Your efforts to get this completed despite various setbacks is noted and I truly appreciate the same.

Driving End-to-End Resolution on Top 3 Data Quality Issues

Top 3 data quality issues are:

- Shadow child ASINs
- Null variation values
- Mismatched website display group resulting in FATALs

Employee Summary:

Our team worked on handling all three of these data quality issues. Out of these three team data quality issues, I implemented a fix for the Shadow Child ASINs data quality problem. Due to schedule constraints, we were unable to properly place this fix outside of mason code. The code involved checking the offers of all shadow children and pruning out extra children based on offer.

The code has to process the children of a given ASIN family after PREPARE statements have already been called. This can be expensive if limits are not placed on the system. With the initial fix we had estimated that there may be performance related issues in the event that there were ASIN families with enough broken data. Fortunately, we would be able to turn off the controlling weblab if needed. It so happened that this was the case. Allen Chen worked on this the second time to limit the scope of the Shadow Child fix in order to be more performant.

Manager Summary:

As of April, we have successfully launched the solution for all the three DQ issues listed above. Though this took longer than planned, the end result has helped improve customer experience. This is another example of design / implementation decision where thinking system / performance implications upfront would have helped reduce churn.

Twister for Books

* Launch Twister For Books with no sev-1 issues in preflight or production.

* Develop logging, graphs, error reporting and ticket creation mechanisms for the Twister for Books backend.

Employee Summary:

Twister for Books was launched without any SEV-1 issues. I worked with Brady Montz to design the back-end layout of Twister for Books (<https://w.amazon.com/index.php/TwisterForBooks/DataFlow>). I worked with Brady Montz and Matt Morrill on various parts of the Twister for Books back-end. Specifically, I built a lot of the back-end test mechanisms for the CARSTBookRanker. Brady Montz was responsible for the creation of most of the backend alarms and monitoring and updated the Twister Monitoring wiki appropriately (https://w.amazon.com/index.php/RCX/TwisterTeam/Monitoring/Services/CARSTBookRanker#NA_-_CARSTBookRanker).

Apart from the testing mechanisms, I was also responsible for modifying the CARSTRankedDataReaderService to read from BDBs as a prototype of Twister for Books data. I was also responsible for building a dumper tool for showing a preview of what the Twister Media Matrix should look like for any given books ASIN.

In regards to front end work, I worked with Allen Chen, Brady Montz and Sulabh Gigras to finish various miscellaneous components of the Twister Media Matrix (Twister for Books front-end) for T4B 2.0. I was responsible for making the changes that were required for Twister for Books 2.5 (<https://w.amazon.com/index.php/TwisterForBooks/Phase2.5>). Additionally I did the work for making the Twister Media Matrix work with CSE. None of these changes have resulted in SEV-1s.

Lastly, I also worked on a prototype for Twister for Books that gave the SITB team the ability to reload their features on the Detail Page in the same way features are reloaded by traditional Twister functionality. This prototype gave them an environment to test the ability of their features to reload via AJAX update.

Manager Summary:

This is one of the most important launches for the company and especially the Twister program. The fact that we can deliver this improved Customer experience, increase authoritativeness, have a positive financial impact and not impact latency is a true success. The important takeaways for you from this project are (1) team work you demonstrated working the folks you have listed above helped you all compliment each other and deliver this solution successfully (2) fixing the root causes that caused the code quality / QA issues on which you got the feedback. (you are showing good improvement & seem to be applying in your recent work, you need to sustain that in all your upcoming goals)

Amazon Goals: TCO

* Manage the Twister Team's hardware, balancing use of hardware with ease of management. Maintain a single global platform where possible, and reduce operational overhead. Handle lease returns, set appropriate alarms, manage VIPs and report quarterly (6/30, 9/30, 12/31) on hardware capacity and utilization.

Employee Summary:

Throughout the last year, I have taken on the management of our team's hardware and services. I have handled the lease returns. I have reorganized our fleet into appropriate global host classes. I have set and fine tuned alarms for our customer facing services such as CARSTRankedDataReaderService and the OtherEditionsService.

For easy access to apollo links, permissions, snitch, infrastructure, VIP, database information, i-graph alarms, and monitoring graphs I created the Twister Monitoring Wiki (<https://w.amazon.com/index.php/Twister/Monitoring>). In the beginning, I focused on only customer facing services. The rest of our services have most of their pertinent information (apollo links, etc..) in the Twister Hostclasses Wiki (<https://w.amazon.com/index.php/Twister/Hostclasses> , which I also created earlier this year). In the Twister Monitoring Wiki, you will find monitoring graphs for latency,

availability, transaction rate, CPU utilization, virtual memory utilization and disk utilization. These monitoring graphs are built through Wiki Templates I wrote in order to limit Wiki code replication across all services/locales in Twister's portfolio.

The alarms I implemented trigger upon client side latencies for avg., tp99, and tp99.9. They also trigger on availability, CPU utilization, memory utilization, and disk utilization. Over the last few months, I have been working to adjust the alarms as needed. Brady and I have been working with Ann Du (our DBA) to get alarms for database specific problems. So far there is an email list that our DBAs will forward information to in the event of an outage. We find that more often than not, when we are unable to connect to our Oracle database it takes some time to determine if the cause is rooted in a problem with our database or a connection there to. This email list is one more step towards getting proper alarms for anytime there is a problem with the database or database connection.

Although it has not occurred on a strictly quarterly basis, I also updated team members as needed when requested for host information.

Throughout this entire process I have worked closely with Brady Montz anytime I had a question or needed advice on the proper way to approach host management. He has also provided host information to the team on many occasions as well as handling various other host management tasks.

Manager Summary:

Agree with your summary. You have been the go to guy for all hardware / environment issues, some of it is mainly due to your own initiative on this - thank you. You & I have discussed in length about the importance of this problems you have address for the team. We have also discussed you spreading this work & knowledge to the rest of the team so that this maintenance work doesn't take away significant portion of your time. You should work with Eric to ensure this is shared by the whole team.

Twister Team Goals: Operations

- * Launch DPF and SCP for all Twister stores worldwide by the end of July.
- * Propose and implement self-service tools to enable anyone to determine quickly if a website problem is a Twister issue or not. Also devise and implement mechanisms so other teams know about these tools to reduce the number of tickets filed for issues we cannot fix. Reduce the number of such tickets by 50% by 11/1/09.
- * Attend the Operational Excellence class by 9/1/2009.

Employee Summary:

DPF and SCP:

This was completed, for more information on this goal, please see my prior remarks concerning DPF and SCP.

Self Service Tools:

For the self service tools, some were proposed while others were quickly implemented on my own. One tool which I quickly implemented on my own was the WATER Trouble Ticket auto-responder and self-help wiki. This year, TAM has been a major strain on Twister from an Operational standpoint. TAM had been sending us multiple tickets a day, most of which had their causes rooted in bad data. Most of the time, this data was not owned by nor could be directly remedied by the Twister Team.

The WATER auto responder is a tool which can be configured to automatically respond to Trouble Ticket requests to a specific CTI. I configured it to provide Trouble Ticket requesters with a courteous message directing them to read our self-help wiki. In the self-help wiki, I posted a number

of solutions to reoccurring problems that would appear in our ticket queue. While initially, we only saw minor impact from this change, over the months, we have seen quite a decrease in TAM tickets. This has slowed the flow of improperly assigned Trouble Tickets coming from TAM a handful per day to one to just a few per week.

Outside of the scope of traditional Twister, Brady and I worked on a data dumper for Twister for Books. This way users are able to see what the ranking logic for the Twister Media Matrix is supposed to look. They are able to see what the content should look like for each row and whether or not the ASIN is being affected by the kindle filter.

In addition, as stated earlier in this self review, I have written many monitoring graphs in wiki for our customer facing services. With these monitoring graphs, users can quickly determine the state of our services in order to quickly assess whether or not it is impacting user experience.

Operational Excellence Class:

I attended the Operation Excellence class this past year (<https://internal.amazon.com/phone/?query=micklos>). The biggest takeaway I had from this class was how crucial focusing on Operational Excellence is. If a team does not make Operational Excellence a top priority, the operational debt can become overwhelming. I attended this class with Michael McDaniel.

Manager Summary:

Agree. Your efforts in setting up the tools / WATER auto-response is highly appreciated.

Identify Strengths

Employee Summary:

- Customer Obsession: One of my main reasons for coming to Amazon was my customer obsession. Writing designing systems which positively impact our customers is what really moves me in the morning. While in the recent past, my focus has been on career development, I have written up ideas and proposals in the past for ways to better the customer experience.

- Innovate & Simplify: Over the last year, this has applied in a number of different places. A good example of this is my work with Ubiquity. The objective of introducing this tool at Amazon was to streamline development tasks within Firefox.

- Exercise Judgment: Exercising judgment is one of my key strengths. A good example of this would be with the recent production SEV-2 that occurred as a result of the Twister build script being broken. After identifying the problem at hand (certain build trying to include JavaScript and CSS from locations that did not exist), I set in motion multiple courses actions to address the matter. I quickly engaged the image service team to help me copy over the JavaScript and CSS to the nonexistent locations. I notified my manager and his manager and began working with QA to decide on whether or not a rollback should occur. While this was happening, I began hypothesizing ways in which we could prevent this from happening in the future. Instead of sitting around waiting for input from teammates, I quickly acted to put in a stop to the broken Twister experience, perform a rollback in case more problems existed as a result of the broken build process and began drawing up ways in which we could fix the build to redeploy.

One aspect of exercising judgment that I have been lacking in in the past is prioritization of tasks that I am working on. I believe that over this past year (especially towards the end) I have fixed this. All work that I do is now properly prioritized and kept track of in a daily log that I keep to track all things that I am currently working on. If I ever have any doubt as to the priority of one project versus the other, I make sure that I first talk to Smita to make sure that we are on the same page in terms of

priority.

In last year's review, I listed delivery as a main area for improvement. In this past year, with proper judgment of project prioritization and time management, I have been able to switch delivery from being a area of improvement to nearly a top strength. By being able to properly gauge

- Have Backbone; Will Disagree and Commit: I am very comfortable with changing my opinion on matters where overwhelming evidence against my opinions is presented. In cases where this does not happen, If I believe in something, I am fairly stubborn without being brutish or out of line.

Manager Summary:

I agree with your self assessment on your strengths but for one 'Exercise Judgement' which I will discuss in areas of improvement.

Other strengths that you have not noted for yourself but have demonstrated throughout the year is Ownership, Team Work, Hard work and Ability to take feedback & work on it. You are good team mate, always willing to help out when needed. Thank you.

Including below are some well deserved feedback from your colleagues and I agree with all of them:

Hustle: Jon is willing to work hard when it's called for. He put in many weekends and late nights to meet tight deadlines. Ownership/Teamwork: Jon is always willing to take tasks that need to be done. He's a team player. He frequently volunteered to take tasks that came in to the team, even when he was already overbooked. He also initiated a series of Twister Everywhere meetings to discuss future architecture. Advocacy/Simplify: In 2009, Jon developed a keen appreciation for the simple. He began something of a personal crusade to eliminate complexity from the team's operational responsibilities. For example, he initiated a series of Twister Everywhere meetings to discuss future architecture

Jon is typically pretty enthusiastic about his work. He works hard to get his tasks done, and is fairly open to feedback and input from others. Also, in the past few months, he has done a good job at protecting his time better. He used to have trouble filtering out distractions and making sure his priorities were straight, but he has made some strides in improving in this area. He has also improved on his thoroughness of testing.

Jon has an intrinsic aptitude in investigating and learning tools and tricks that can help increase productivity(such as the Ubiquity tools , which have earned me Environment Ninja status). He also showed great enthusiasm in attempting to design an automated testing environment for QA. When he is focused, he does a good job of completing tasks and reporting progress(from what I have seen on host migration/VMDC migration mails he has sent out). He is also great at organizing team events and keeping up the spirit of camaraderie. He worked hard in concert with the Messaging team to help iron out issues with CARS queue processing, and helped identify and fix several issues there.

Jonathan has a very strong focus on Amazon's business needs, and strong instincts for doing things "the right way." When working with him this summer on the Twister For Books project, he displayed a good knack for managing our project schedules (and improving how we did so), and has been consistently proactive on cleaning up a lot of problems that the Twister Team had (hostclass configuration, monitoring, tickets, code reviews, etc.) Early in the year, we had an incident where the whole TPED/AMP/Message Process stack had failed for some time, without anyone noticing outside of the media services team (who was filing an increasing number of increasingly panicked tickets on us). Jonathan did a top-notch job of figuring out all of the root problems (and there were many), and systematically fixing the ones that he could fix, and enlisting help from other teams (such as media services and the owners of AMP) for the parts he couldn't do himself. He did a better job of dealing with that complex nest of problems than many junior engineers would. Jonathan is also quite smart,

and has good thoughts on high-level things (like twister for everywhere, etc.). He's particularly good at dealing with and helping the people who have problems with our code. He's an adaptable thinker, and tends not to get bogged down in one methodology or tied to any particular tool. Jonathan is also very aware of his limitations, and has been working hard on improving them this year.

Jon is a great developer. He has a fantastic balance of intelligence, bias for action, and communication skills. Whenever I find a potential bug, he is always eager to jump into the 'fray' and investigate the issue, even though it is usually a bug that he didn't introduce. He rarely needs more than a few minutes to diagnose an issue, and, beyond that, he rarely needs more than a few minutes to have a fix made and out for review. I believe many engineers throughout the company could learn from his enthusiasm and solid engineering skills. His ability to communicate clearly and succinctly makes him a very effective and efficient SDE. He also makes himself available around the clock. I'll fire off questions to him shortly before (and, sometimes, well past) midnight, and he'll often respond within minutes.

Jon has excellent communication and technical skills. He starts out each conversation with a highly enthusiastic note and gives a feel that is pretty interested in what we have to say. When he has something on which he wants others' opinion, he would be glad to welcome suggestions and constructive criticism, like he asked for my opinion on Twister Everywhere project. When a problem is stated, with the amount of exposure he gained so far and the breadth of knowledge he has, he would understand lot more than what we say and he states clearly his conclusions for validation. Its sheer fun working with him which made my late night catch-up and CR requests much easier. On code reviews he comes up with good thoughtful comments and expects good quality (with out missing any edge cases or having any performance impacts). He would have a thorough look at the test-port before he signs-off on anything.

Jon has very good intentions and shows a willingness to learn. He tries very hard. He also solicits feedback and appreciates constructive feedback, which is good because he is not meeting the bar on Amazon SDE Core principles. The following are areas where he has started showing improvements but is still not meeting the bar: - Drive quality: Jon is making an attempt to get better at the code quality by documenting every project and writing use cases to ensure he covers all critical paths. This is a good habit as very recently he has shown signs of improvement in his code quality - Deliver Results: he is working very hard recently to meet deadlines.

Identify Areas for Improvement

Employee Summary:

- Communicate Clearly: I am a communicator, I like to communicate. Unfortunately, I find that I am not the most efficient at communicating the ideas I want to convey. There are three areas I want to work on.

1. Context and Scope: In conversation and email, I am working on making sure that I am only giving the recipient the amount of information they need and no more. In the past I have had a habit of explaining (at length) extra information that the recipient does not need. On the opposite side, I have also been guilty of not giving enough information. In email and in person, I need to first think about/find out what the person already knows and what they really need to know in order to get to the sought after end.

2. Objective: I need to learn to better craft my conversations in emails so that I am not directly exposing the what objective I am trying to achieve. As an example, this can be useful in situations where a project requires other teams to perform work. It is better to have them first think it is a good idea than to directly ask them to work on something.

3. Direction: I also want to work on the ability to properly steer conversation. This goes well with objective. In conversation, you may need the ability to keep conversation on track or move it in a new direction. There are times where I find that my conversations get hijacked. I would like to be able to prevent this in the future and even hijack conversations in the future (on my own) where need

be.

Manager Summary:

Other key improvement areas that you need to continue to improve, focus and sustain are delivering quality work, comprehensiveness, achieving the right results (and staying focused), and sticking to schedule commitments.

As listed above in my overall summary, you rightly recognize these areas, working actively with your team (last 6 months) to understand and showing good improvements. The results that you have shown so far is very encouraging, but., I am listing it here so that you know that you need to sustain these improvements and consistently deliver high quality work and on time every time.

Verbatims from your colleagues:

Functional Skills: Jon struggled with code quality for most of 2009. Code reviewers had many comments and changes were often required. Jon also didn't fully appreciate the complexity of the system, the result being that many of his solutions would make it to production with significant problems requiring re-work. This began to trend more favorably toward the end of the year. Right Results/Time Management: Jon had some challenges with time management and prioritization in 2009. For example, project deadlines took a back seat to more optional work on several occasions. This had started to move in the right direction by mid-year, and he was asking the right questions and working on the right stuff by year-end.

Jon needs to focus on consistent delivery of the right results, on being a dependable, go-to domain expert in something the team needs, and thinking with a broader (team-level or RCX-wide) focus.

While Jonathan has improved a lot, he does still have some critical areas to develop: 1. He's often careless in his coding, and when he feels rushed, he tends to make simple mistakes that would be prevented with a bit more thought or testing. 2. Related to #1, he has learned some hard lessons this year about how to make more clear to people how much time he needs to properly test things. He is eager to please, and will easily allow himself to end up with less time than he knows he needs to get something done. He is starting to be more honest with himself and others in his scopings. 3. He's easily distracted. When working on one thing, it's easy for him to notice some other problem that needs fixing, and detour to deal with that. After a few iterations of this, he's hopeless entangled in multiple concurrent and intertwined projects. 4. He's good at starting projects and coming up with great ideas. It's harder for him to see them through; or to even park them in a way where it's easy for others to pick them up and run with them (now or in the future). 5. Early in the year, I had more doubts about his raw development skills. I noticed that this started improving, and we've recently talked about how he's starting to enjoy coding again. So, in addition to the development area that every developer always has (never stop improving your skills), he has the addition one of learning how to be responsible for his own mental state and morale. He's too easily affected by others. 6. He tries so hard to be helpful to everyone, that it impairs his ability to be reliable to anyone.

Generally, his strengths and weaknesses are very related. He's a very quick, intuitive, proactive, thoughtful, and well-networked developer. He's also hasty, careless, impetuous, distractible, and needs to be more independent. This mix can work for him very well if he learns how to manage and harness it. Over this year, he has made significant progress on this, but needs to continue working on this.

I see no concerns with him based on the communication we had over phone and interactions over the course of my tenure here. It would be good if he gives more focus and time for the ticket queue which is a combined team responsibility.

Unfortunately, some of my comments here will be similar to last year. Jon is still having some trouble delivering quality solutions on his own. He still often requires a lot of hand holding and assistance in order to complete a project. When left to his own, it is not that uncommon to find major gaps or

deficiencies during testing. I think a big part is that he needs to be better at seeing problems at the big picture level. He will sometimes make a code that that appears to fix the problem at hand, but doesn't take into account what side effects might occur. The end result is often code that is of sub-par quality and causes issues.

My interactions with Jon the past year have been limited to a few Twister and CARS issues. I have noticed, though several possible areas of development for Jon. I think Jon should try and focus more on the task at hand and not to get too distracted by the desire to probe into other tools and technologies and let these eat into his work time. He should try and improve his time management and get tasks completed within the time allotted so he is supporting the team better. He should also try and spend the necessary cycles to dive deep and understand all aspects of the projects that he is working on , so over time he is able to execute on various tasks more independently. I have noticed that on Twister and CARS Jon tends to always rely on guidance from others for many projects, which slows down the overall execution and sometime lead to wrong decisions(e.g he did not identify the right way to configure EMWA and made some incorrect assumptions not knowing the complete design). I feel he is a smart person and I think he should take more ownership of tasks and build up his expertise on the areas he is responsible for (Twister/CARS), so he can execute independently and with higher quality. I have also noticed that Jon seems to be bogged down with web environment and host issues, and suggest he should take the time out to fix these and not let these affect all his work or of those around him.

My review for Jon has not changed since last year. Jon needs to improve on: - prioritization, avoid getting side-tracked, deliver quality results: Every project that Jon has worked on has been delayed and has had major bugs. He tends to set up meetings or get involved with projects that he is not working on. - Improve end-to-end understanding of the software of his own team. There are basics of the twister code and architecture that he does not understand. - develop functional skills for the role: technical skills (e.g. design, development, building schedules, coding, etc), ability to multi-task.

Jon has,I feel potential to be a very good SDE and should focus his energies more on task completion with high quality and on building up his domain expertise which are probably his main areas of weakness right now.

Development Activities

Development Goals: SDE

* Present a brownbag on a topic of interest to the development community in Q2. [Ubiquity]

Employee Summary:

In the second quarter of 2009 I presented during a brownbag on the topic of the Mozilla Labs project Ubiquity (<http://mozillalabs.com/blog/2008/08/introducing-ubiquity/>).

At the time, Ubiquity was a command line interface and JavaScript library for controlling Firefox. It had a custom popover display that could have content published to it through the Ubiquity JavaScript libraries.

I wrote many internal Amazon tools for this platform. These included tools for modulating weblabs, accessing each one of the various PA Tire-Kicker methods and quickly accessing phone-tool information with a custom phone-tool interface. Much in the same way that custom unix scripts are built by Amazonians to help speed up development on the Unix command line, the host of tools I wrote were meant to speed up development while working in the browser.

Before and after the brown bag, I got other Amazonians to contribute to the project. Adoption at Amazon picked up through the Environment Improvement Ninjas. Their internal site was used for

hosting all of the JavaScript Ubiquity Command Line Utilities. I used their mailing list to initially get information out about the general Mozilla Labs project and the internal Amazon efforts. Eventually I transitioned to having a ubiquity-interest mailing list. For my work, I received an Environment Ninja Master award (<https://internal.amazon.com/phone/?query=micklos>).

At this point, I held a brownbag in order to present Ubiquity (the Mozilla Labs project) and the tools that we had been creating. This forum gave me the opportunity to present this information outside of my immediate peer group and outside of the Environment Improvement Ninjas mailing list. I prepared a full presentation complete with examples. With technologies such as Ubiquity, demonstrations are near necessary for capturing the audience and driving them to act. Unfortunately, the room's network jacks were not working. Additionally, the room was/is a wireless dead spot. I discussed the tool at length, the direction of the project at large, the direction of the project at Amazon and tools created by the community here at Amazon. Fortunately, I had backup examples and screenshots of a few of the tools that had been created. With those, the presentation went well and the project gained more contributors.

Unfortunately, with the second major release of Ubiquity, the API has changed near entirely. This has ultimately led to partial abandonment of the project at large. The google-groups mailing list has more or less gone dead. In addition to these problems, a significant Firefox performance impact was becoming noticeable with the plugin. As a result, despite its utility, I chose to stop using it as one of my development tools.

Manager Summary:

Ratings

Performance Rating: Improvement Needed

Leadership Principles Rating: Solid Strength